

PAINTBOOKCO.

The PaintBook Company Ltd

Privacy Policy

Company Number: 16690724

Registered in England and Wales

Version 1.0 | April 2026

Effective Date: 10th April 2026

1. Who We Are

The PaintBook Company Ltd (trading as PaintBookCo) is a company incorporated in England and Wales (Company Number: 16690724). We operate the PaintBookCo platform, accessible at paintbookco.co.uk, which is the UK's first painter-only digital marketplace connecting professional painters and decorators with customers seeking painting services.

Detail	Information
Legal name	The PaintBook Company Ltd
Trading name	PaintBookCo
Company number	16690724
Registered address	1, 1 Fenman Mews, Walkden, Manchester, UK. M28 3YU
Website	paintbookco.co.uk
Contact email	privacy@paintbookco.co.uk
ICO Registration number	ZC118117

In this Privacy Policy, 'we', 'us', and 'our' refer to The PaintBook Company Ltd. 'Platform' refers to the PaintBookCo website and any associated services. 'You' refers to any person who uses or accesses the Platform, whether as a customer seeking painting services, a painter or decorator registering to offer services, or a visitor to our website.

2. What This Policy Covers

This Privacy Policy explains:

- What personal data we collect about you and why we collect it
- The legal basis we rely on for processing your personal data
- How we use your personal data

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- Who we share your personal data with
 - How long we keep your personal data
 - Your rights under UK GDPR and how to exercise them
 - How to contact us with questions or complaints

This policy applies to all personal data we process in connection with the PaintBookCo platform, including data collected when you register an account, post or accept a job, make or receive a payment through our escrow system, use the Paint Vestimator tool, or communicate with us or other users through the platform.

This policy does not cover third-party websites, services, or platforms that you may access via links on our Platform. Those third parties have their own privacy policies which we encourage you to read.

3. Data Controller

The PaintBook Company Ltd is the data controller for all personal data processed through the PaintBookCo platform. This means we determine the purposes and means of processing your personal data.

We are registered with the Information Commissioner's Office (ICO) as a data controller. Our ICO registration number is ZC118117

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If you have any questions about this Privacy Policy or how we handle your personal data, please contact us at privacy@paintbookco.co.uk

4. Personal Data We Collect

We collect and process the following categories of personal data, depending on how you use our Platform:

4.1 Data You Provide Directly

Account Registration Data (All Users)

- Full name
- Email address
- Password (stored in encrypted form — we never see your plain-text password)
- User type (customer or painter/decorator)

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- Profile photo (optional)

Painter/Decorator-Specific Data

- Proof of identity (passport or driving licence) — uploaded for KYC verification
- Proof of address (utility bill or bank statement) — uploaded for KYC verification
- Public liability insurance certificate
- Trade qualifications and certifications (optional)
- Portfolio photographs and project descriptions
- Service area (postcodes and geographic coverage)
- Specialisms (e.g. interior, exterior, commercial, decorative)
- Availability dates
- Bank account details for payment via Transpact (stored securely by Transpact, not by PaintBookCo directly)
- Business name (if applicable)

Customer-Specific Data

- Property details for job postings (address, type of work required, room dimensions)
- Photographs of spaces to be painted (uploaded via Paint Vestimator or job posting)
- Paint preferences and colour choices
- Budget and timeline requirements
- Payment details (processed securely by Transpact — PaintBookCo does not store card or bank details)

Communications Data

- Messages sent through the PaintBookCo in-platform chat system (job-scoped, monitored for prohibited content)
- Support queries and correspondence with PaintBookCo
- Reviews and ratings submitted after job completion

4.2 Data We Collect Automatically

When you use our Platform, we automatically collect certain technical data:

- IP address
- Browser type and version
- Device type and operating system
- Pages visited and time spent on the Platform
- Referring website or search terms used to find us
- Session duration and activity logs
- Approximate geographic location (derived from IP address, not GPS)

This data is collected using cookies and similar tracking technologies. For more information, please see our Cookie Policy.

4.3 Data from Third Parties

- Transact (our escrow provider): Transaction reference numbers and payment status information to enable us to manage job payments and releases.
- Identity verification providers: Confirmation of KYC verification outcomes (we receive the result, not the underlying verification process data).
- Google Analytics and similar analytics tools: Aggregated, anonymised data about how users interact with our Platform.

5. Why We Process Your Data and Our Lawful Basis

Under UK GDPR, we must have a lawful basis for every purpose for which we process your personal data. The table below sets out the main purposes for which we process personal data and the lawful basis we rely on for each.

Purpose	Lawful Basis	Details
Creating and managing your account	Contract	Processing is necessary to perform the contract between you and PaintBookCo (our Terms of Service).
KYC identity verification for painters	Contract + Legal obligation	We must verify painter identities to perform our service safely and to meet our obligations under UK Anti-Money Laundering Regulations.
Matching customers with painters	Contract	Core to the service we provide — necessary to fulfil your use of the Platform.
Processing payments via Transact escrow	Contract	Escrow payment processing is integral to every transaction on the Platform and necessary to perform the service.
Deducting and processing PaintBookCo commission	Contract	Commission is agreed in our Terms of Service and forms the commercial basis of the Platform.
Sending transactional emails (job notifications, payment confirmations, KYC decisions)	Contract	Necessary to provide the service you have signed up for.
In-platform messaging (moderated chat)	Contract + Legitimate interests	Necessary to facilitate job communication; monitored to enforce Platform rules and protect commercial interests.
Fraud detection and security monitoring	Legitimate interests	We have a legitimate interest in protecting our Platform, users, and commercial model from fraud and abuse.
Paint Vestimator usage (room dimensions, photos, estimates)	Contract + Consent	Necessary to provide the estimation tool; images processed only for the purpose for which they are uploaded.

Platform analytics and performance monitoring	Legitimate interests	We have a legitimate interest in understanding how our Platform is used to improve it.
Marketing communications (with your consent)	Consent	We will only send marketing emails where you have explicitly opted in. You can withdraw consent at any time.
Legal compliance (GDPR, AML, HMRC records)	Legal obligation	We are required by law to maintain certain records and respond to regulatory requests.
Dispute resolution	Legitimate interests + Contract	We have a legitimate interest in resolving disputes fairly and maintaining accurate records of transactions.

6. How We Use Your Personal Data

6.1 Providing the Platform Service

- Creating and maintaining your account
- Verifying painter and decorator identities and credentials (KYC)
- Matching customers with eligible, verified painters based on location, specialism, and availability
- Facilitating job postings, quotes, and bookings
- Processing payments and commission through our FCA-regulated escrow partner Transact
- Releasing funds to painters upon confirmed job completion
- Sending you notifications about your jobs, payments, and account status

6.2 Safety, Security, and Fraud Prevention

- Monitoring in-platform communications to detect and prevent sharing of personal contact information (which is prohibited under our Terms of Service to protect the commercial integrity of the Platform)
- Detecting and preventing fraudulent accounts, fake portfolios, and identity misrepresentation
- Maintaining security logs and audit trails of sensitive actions (KYC decisions, payment operations, dispute resolutions)
- Conducting security monitoring via Sentry error tracking and related tools

6.3 Communications

- Sending transactional emails related to your account activity (job alerts, payment confirmations, KYC outcomes, review requests)
- Responding to support queries and complaints

- Sending marketing communications only where you have explicitly opted in. You can unsubscribe at any time by clicking the unsubscribe link in any marketing email or by contacting us at m&c@paintbookco.co.uk.

6.4 Platform Improvement

- Analysing platform usage patterns (using anonymised or aggregated data) to improve our features and user experience
- Building and improving the Paint Vestimator — we may use anonymised and aggregated data from completed jobs (dimensions, paint quantities, pricing) to improve estimation accuracy. We will never share identifiable personal data for this purpose.
- Conducting A/B testing of platform features

6.5 Legal and Regulatory Compliance

- Maintaining records required by HMRC (7-year retention for financial records)
- Maintaining KYC records as required by UK Money Laundering Regulations (5-year retention post-transaction)
- Responding to lawful requests from regulatory authorities (including the ICO, HMRC, or law enforcement)
- Defending legal claims or enforcing our Terms of Service

7. Who We Share Your Personal Data With

We do not sell your personal data. We do not share your personal data with third parties for their own marketing purposes. We share your data only in the circumstances described below.

Recipient	Why We Share Data	Data Shared
Transpact (escrow provider)	To process payments, hold funds in escrow, release payments to painters, and handle any reversals or cancellations. Transpact is FCA-authorised (Ref: 546279).	Transaction amounts, party email addresses, transaction reference numbers, payment status.
Supabase (database infrastructure)	Hosting and managing our platform database, which stores all account, job, and transaction records. Supabase operates on AWS infrastructure with data stored in the EU (Ireland region).	All personal data held on the platform: name, email, account details, job records, KYC status, payment references, and activity logs.

Didit (KYC/AML verification)	Verifying the identity of painters during onboarding in accordance with our AML obligations. Didit processes identity documents and performs automated checks on our behalf.	Full name, date of birth, government-issued identity documents, selfie/liveness data, and verification outcome.
AWS S3 (Amazon Web Services)	Secure storage of KYC documents and platform assets uploaded by painters. Documents are stored in the UK (London region) with encryption at rest.	KYC identity documents, proof of address, insurance certificates.
SendGrid (email delivery)	Sending transactional and notification emails on our behalf.	Email address, name, and relevant job or account information needed to personalise emails.
Stream Chat (in-platform messaging)	Providing the in-platform messaging system between matched painters and customers. EU data region selected.	User IDs, display names, and message content within job-specific channels.
Make.com (workflow automation)	Automating platform workflows including KYC approvals, job notifications, payment triggers, and CRM updates. Personal data passes through Make.com in transit as part of these automated processes.	Name, email, job status, KYC outcome, and transaction references, depending on the workflow triggered.
Stacksync (data synchronisation)	Synchronising platform data between our database (Supabase) and our CRM (HubSpot) in real time.	Name, email, job status, and account activity data.
HubSpot (CRM)	Managing our business operations, pipeline tracking, and customer support. Data is synced from Supabase via Stacksync.	Name, email, job status, account activity. Used for operational management only, not marketing without consent.
Sentry (error monitoring)	Monitoring our platform for technical errors to maintain uptime and performance.	Error logs, which may include anonymised technical data. No personal content is intentionally captured.
SightEngine (content moderation)	AI-powered detection of personal contact information in chat messages to enforce our prohibited content policy.	Message text submitted for moderation. SightEngine does not retain message content after analysis.

Analytics providers (Google Analytics)	Understanding how users interact with our Platform to improve it.	Anonymised usage data, page views, session data, and device/browser information. No directly identifying personal data is intentionally collected.
Legal and regulatory authorities	Where required by law, court order, or regulatory request (e.g. ICO, HMRC, law enforcement).	Relevant data as required by the applicable legal obligation.
Professional advisors (solicitors, accountants)	To receive professional advice in relation to our business operations.	Relevant data as required, shared on a strictly confidential basis.

Sharing Between Painters and Customers

When a job is confirmed and escrow is funded, PaintBookCo will share necessary contact information between the matched painter and customer via a system-generated email. This is the only mechanism by which contact details are exchanged. Contact details are never shared directly in the in-platform chat system.

Painter profiles (name, portfolio, ratings, service area, and specialism) are visible to customers searching for painters on the Platform.

8. International Data Transfers

PaintBookCo is a UK-based company and we store the majority of your personal data within the UK and the European Economic Area (EEA). Some of our third-party service providers may process data outside the UK/EEA. Where this occurs, we ensure appropriate safeguards are in place:

- AWS (KYC document storage) — EU-West-2 (London) region. Data does not leave the UK.
- SendGrid (email delivery) — US-based. We rely on Standard Contractual Clauses (SCCs) as the transfer mechanism. SendGrid maintains GDPR compliance documentation available at their Trust Portal.
- Stream Chat — EU data region selected. Data processed within the EEA.
- HubSpot — US-based. We rely on Standard Contractual Clauses (SCCs) and HubSpot's Data Processing Agreement.
- Transact — UK-based, FCA-authorised. All funds held under UK law.

You have the right to request information about the specific safeguards we have in place for any international transfers. Please contact us at [INSERT EMAIL].

9. How Long We Keep Your Personal Data

We keep your personal data only for as long as is necessary for the purposes described in this policy or as required by law. The table below sets out our standard retention periods.

Data Category	Retention Period	Reason
Account data (name, email, profile)	Duration of account + 3 years after last activity	To resolve any queries or disputes that may arise after account closure.
KYC documents (identity, address, insurance)	5 years from the date of the last transaction	UK Money Laundering Regulations 2017 — legal obligation.
Payment and transaction records	7 years from the date of transaction	HMRC requirements for financial records.
In-platform chat messages	180 days (6 months) from the date of the message	To support dispute resolution during and after a job. Extended retention available on request where a dispute is ongoing.
Job details (job postings, milestone records)	Duration of job + 3 years	To support disputes, reviews, and platform improvement.
Paint Vestimator data (room photos, dimensions)	Duration of job + 12 months, then anonymised	Photos used only for estimation purposes. Anonymised aggregate data retained for product improvement.
Message block log (PII filter incidents)	2 years	For security monitoring and enforcement of our prohibited content policy.
Marketing consent records	Until consent is withdrawn + 3 years	To demonstrate compliance with PECR.
Support correspondence	3 years from resolution	To handle any follow-up queries.
Audit logs (admin actions, KYC decisions, payment operations)	7 years	Legal compliance and ability to demonstrate accountability.

When personal data is no longer required, we will securely delete or anonymise it. Where anonymisation is not possible (for example, data embedded in backup systems), we will isolate the data from further processing until deletion is possible.

10. Your Rights Under UK GDPR

You have the following rights in relation to your personal data. These rights apply to the extent permitted by applicable law and may be subject to certain limitations where we have overriding legal obligations to retain data.

Right	What It Means	How to Exercise It
Right of access	You can request a copy of the personal data we hold about you (a Subject Access Request or SAR).	Contact us at privacy@paintbookco.co.uk . We will respond within 30 days. We do not charge a fee for standard requests.
Right to rectification	You can ask us to correct inaccurate or incomplete personal data we hold about you.	Contact us at privacy@paintbookco.co.uk or update your details directly in your account settings.
Right to erasure ('right to be forgotten')	You can ask us to delete your personal data in certain circumstances.	Contact us at privacy@paintbookco.co.uk . Note: we may be required to retain some data for legal reasons (e.g. KYC records, financial records). We will explain any limitations that apply.
Right to restrict processing	You can ask us to pause processing of your personal data in certain circumstances, such as while you contest the accuracy of data we hold.	Contact us at privacy@paintbookco.co.uk .
Right to data portability	You can request a copy of the personal data you have provided to us in a structured, machine-readable format.	Contact us at privacy@paintbookco.co.uk . Available where processing is based on consent or contract.
Right to object	You can object to processing based on legitimate interests, including profiling. You can also object to direct marketing at any time.	Contact us at privacy@paintbookco.co.uk , or use the unsubscribe link in any marketing email.
Right to withdraw consent	Where processing is based on your consent, you can withdraw that consent at any time without affecting the lawfulness of processing before withdrawal.	Contact us at privacy@paintbookco.co.uk or use the unsubscribe link in any marketing email.
Rights related to automated decision-making	You have the right not to be subject to decisions made solely by automated processing that significantly affect you.	Our matching and moderation systems involve human oversight for significant decisions. Contact us at privacy@paintbookco.co.uk if you have concerns.

How to Submit a Data Request

To exercise any of the above rights, please contact us at privacy@paintbookco.co.uk with the subject line 'Data Rights Request'. Please include:

- Your full name and the email address associated with your PaintBookCo account
- The specific right you wish to exercise
- Any additional details that will help us locate the relevant data

We will respond within 30 calendar days. If your request is complex or you have submitted multiple requests, we may extend this by a further two months, in which case we will notify you.

Right to Complain

If you are unhappy with how we handle your personal data, you have the right to lodge a complaint with the UK's Information Commissioner's Office (ICO):

ICO Contact Details

Website: ico.org.uk

Telephone: 0303 123 1113

Address: Information Commissioner's Office, Wycliffe House, Water Lane, Wilmslow, Cheshire, SK9 5AF

We would appreciate the opportunity to resolve any complaint directly before you contact the ICO. Please contact us first at privacy@paintbookco.co.uk.

11. Cookies

We use cookies and similar tracking technologies on our Platform. Cookies are small text files placed on your device that help us provide and improve our service.

Types of Cookies We Use

Cookie Type	Purpose	Can You Opt Out?
Strictly necessary	Required for the Platform to function — session management, authentication, security tokens.	No — these are essential to the service.
Performance/analytics	Help us understand how users interact with our Platform (e.g. Google Analytics). Data is anonymised.	Yes — via our cookie consent banner.
Functional	Remember your preferences (e.g. language settings, saved searches).	Yes — via our cookie consent banner.
Marketing	We do not currently use marketing/advertising cookies. If this changes, we will update this policy.	N/A

You can manage your cookie preferences at any time via the cookie settings link in the footer of our website. You can also control cookies through your browser settings, although this may affect your ability to use certain features of our Platform.

For full details of the cookies we use, please see our Cookie Policy at paintbookco.co.uk/cookies.

12. How We Protect Your Data

We take the security of your personal data seriously and have implemented technical and organisational measures appropriate to the nature of the data we process. These include:

- Encryption of data in transit (TLS/HTTPS on all Platform communications)
- Encryption of data at rest (AWS S3 server-side encryption for KYC documents)
- Access controls: only authorised personnel can access personal data, using role-based access and multi-factor authentication
- Row-level security on our database: users can only access their own data
- KYC documents accessible only via short-lived signed URLs (maximum 5 minutes) — documents are never publicly accessible
- Regular security monitoring via Sentry and periodic penetration testing
- PII filtering in chat communications to prevent inadvertent sharing of contact details
- Immutable audit logging of all sensitive administrative actions

Despite these measures, no system is completely secure. If you believe your account has been compromised, please contact us immediately at privacy@paintbookco.co.uk.

Data Breach Notification

In the event of a personal data breach that is likely to result in a risk to your rights and freedoms, we will notify the ICO within 72 hours of becoming aware of the breach. Where the breach is likely to result in a high risk to your rights and freedoms, we will also notify you directly without undue delay.

13. Children's Privacy

The PaintBookCo Platform is not directed at children under the age of 18. We do not knowingly collect personal data from anyone under 18 years of age. If you are under 18, please do not register for an account or submit any personal data through the Platform.

If we become aware that we have inadvertently collected personal data from a person under the age of 18, we will take prompt steps to delete that data. If you believe we may have collected data from a child, please contact us at privacy@paintbookco.co.uk.

14. Third-Party Links and Services

Our Platform may contain links to third-party websites, services, or resources (for example, links to paint manufacturer websites or to our escrow partner Transpact). These third parties have their own privacy policies. PaintBookCo is not responsible for the privacy practices of third-party websites, and we encourage you to read their privacy policies before providing any personal data to them.

Where we integrate third-party tools or services within our Platform (such as the Floori colour visualisation tool in the Paint Vestimator), we ensure appropriate data processing agreements are in place. However, your use of these integrated tools may be subject to the third party's own terms.

15. Changes to This Privacy Policy

We may update this Privacy Policy from time to time to reflect changes to our data practices, the services we offer, or applicable law. When we make material changes, we will:

- Update the 'Version' and 'Effective Date' at the top of this policy
- Post a notice on the PaintBookCo Platform informing users of the update
- Where required by law or where changes significantly affect your rights, notify you directly by email

We encourage you to review this Privacy Policy periodically. Continued use of the Platform after a change to this policy constitutes your acceptance of the updated terms, subject to your rights to object or withdraw consent where applicable.

Previous versions of this policy are available on request by contacting us at privacy@paintbookco.co.uk.

16. How to Contact Us

If you have any questions, concerns, or requests in relation to this Privacy Policy or the way we handle your personal data, please contact us:

Contact Details

The PaintBook Company Ltd
Company Number: 16690724
Email: privacy@paintbookco.co.uk
Website: paintbookco.co.uk
Registered address: 1, 1 Fenman Mews, Walkden, Manchester, UK. M28 3YU

For data rights requests, please email us with the subject line: 'Data Rights Request'
For general privacy queries, please email us with the subject line: 'Privacy Query'
We aim to respond to all enquiries within 5 working days.

If you are not satisfied with our response, you have the right to complain to the Information Commissioner's Office at ico.org.uk or by calling 0303 123 1113.

Appendix: Before-You-Publish Checklist

This document was prepared as a working draft in April 2026 for The PaintBook Company Ltd. It should be reviewed by a qualified solicitor or data protection specialist before publication and whenever material changes to data practices occur.